CARAMELIZED ONION AND PARMIGIANO FILLING

INGREDIENTS

228 g	Country bread, torn into pieces
56 g	Olive oil, for the bread crumbs
10 g	Garlic
125 g	Olive oil, for the onions
60 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
1.8 kg	Yellow onions, thinly sliced
237 g	Water
2 sprigs	Rosemary
2 sprigs	Thyme
60 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
quantity not given	Salt
quantity not given	Black pepper

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 200°F.
2. Spread the torn bread over a sheet pan and dry it out in the oven for 30 to 45 minutes. It should take no color at all. Crush a shard with the back of a spoon to check, the inside has to be bone dry. Let it cool.
3. Pulse the cooled bread in a food processor down to fine crumbs, stopping while they still have some texture rather than turning to dust.
4. Set a saute pan over medium-low heat with the 56 g olive oil and the garlic. Cook 1 to 2 minutes, until the garlic scents the oil, then lift the garlic out and keep it for another use.
5. Drop the heat to low, add the crumbs and stir now and then until golden brown, 5 to 8 minutes. Drain them on a paper-towel-lined plate and let them cool.
6. Weigh out 104 g of crumbs for the filling. The rest keeps in an airtight container somewhere cool and dry for a week.
7. Warm the 125 g oil and the butter together in a large Dutch oven set over low heat, swirling them into each other.
8. Add the onions and turn them so every slice carries the fat. Cook 10 to 15 minutes until soft and translucent, stirring occasionally so nothing catches.
9. Pour in the water. Tie the rosemary and thyme into a bundle with kitchen twine and bury it in the pot.
10. Lay a sheet of parchment directly on the onions and cook 2 to 3 hours, lifting the paper to stir from time to time, until they have collapsed completely and gone deep brown. By then the water should all have evaporated. Take the pot off the heat and let it cool.
11. Blend the cooled onions smooth in a high-speed blender.
12. Scrape the puree into a bowl, fold in the 104 g bread crumbs and the parmigiano, and season with salt and pepper. Cover and refrigerate until you shape the pasta.

NOTES

Only 104 g of the crumbs goes into the filling. The batch is larger on purpose and the surplus keeps a week in an airtight container.
The crumbs and the parmigiano bind the onion puree and add creaminess to it.
Parchment laid straight onto the onions stops them drying out over the 2 to 3 hours it takes them to go deep brown.
Pulse the bread only as far as fine crumbs with some texture left. Dust will not bind.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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